

Kunalan Kevin Subagaran

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Summary

Backend/platform engineer focused on reliability, observability, self-hosted infrastructure, and developer-facing systems. Owns production services end-to-end: design, rollout, migration, on-call ownership, and measurable cost/reliability outcomes.

Technical Skills

Languages: Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, Python, SQL, Rust, Java, Bash, C

Backend/Platform: Distributed systems, service ownership, REST, GraphQL, gRPC, WebSockets, Node.js, Gin, Express.js

Data/Infra: PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, ClickHouse, MongoDB, DynamoDB

Cloud/Operations: AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, Pulumi, observability, CI/CD

Experience

Retool

July 2023 - Present

Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA

- Designed and shipped first-party analytics ingestion platform replacing Amplitude dependency; processed **5M+ events/day** while restoring control over event schemas, routing, and experimentation data
- Led Datadog-to-self-hosted observability migration across production services, maintaining dashboard and alert parity for on-call teams while saving **\$750K+ annually**
- Standardized React Error Boundary reporting into a company-wide reliability program, defining ownership, routing, and remediation workflows that reduced crash volume by **95%**
- Created endpoint ownership routing for production pages and services, mapping alerts and incidents to accountable teams and reducing on-call triage time
- Built on-prem telemetry agent for self-hosted deployments, exposing customer health, product usage, and support diagnostics to engineering and support teams without direct production access
- Reduced p95 latency on core product routes from **2s to 200ms (90% faster)** by adding cache layers, removing inefficient async waterfalls, and optimizing database queries
- Owned enterprise platform customization for Apple and NBCU, shipping reliability-sensitive rollout work that supported **\$2.5M+ ARR**

Snapchat

May 2022 - August 2022

Software Engineer Intern

Toronto, ON

- Implemented hybrid encryption workflows across AWS and GCP protecting sensitive data paths for **100M+ users**
- Built model-training data microservice handling **1.7M+ requests/day**, improving reliability and freshness of inputs used for AR filter training

Bonsai

Jan 2021 - August 2021

Software Developer Intern

Toronto, ON

- Engineered external order-fulfillment system that processed **\$1.6M+ GMV** in its first 2 months and expanded partner commerce capacity
- Shipped partner dashboard workflows for search, filtering, exports, and product verification, reducing manual operations work for fulfillment teams
- Migrated embedded commerce widget from React to Preact, reducing bundle size by **40%** and improving storefront load performance

Projects

CSCareers.dev | *Golang, PostgreSQL, SQL, Webhooks*

- Founded and launched Go/PostgreSQL job-search platform with Simplify (YC Startup) partnership, building the ingest, search, and application workflow for internship and new-grad roles
- Operated the largest CS Discord community and converted distribution into **100K+ users**, creating a low-cost acquisition channel and feedback loop for product roadmap decisions

Education

Queen's University

September 2019 - May 2023

Bachelor of Computing (Honours) in Software Design

Kingston, ON

- Awards:** Ratehub.ca Award in Computing, Dean's Honour List × 4